

BERNERA NEWS

A Community Newsletter 
in association with

BERNERA BRIDGE UPDATE

Statement from Comhairle nan Eilean Siar, 5th November 2020

The bridge to Bernera was constructed in 1952/53 utilising post tensioned concrete technology, which was an emerging advancement in structural engineering. There is specific inspection guidance for this type of bridge which, based on a risk assessment process, may require an intrusive survey (cutting into the concrete structure to expose the steel tendons for inspection). Bernera Bridge was intrusively inspected in 1998, following collapse of a similar structure, and was found to be structurally sound. Due to the intrusive nature of this type of survey a period of eighteen years is the recommended timescale between such surveys. A principle inspection on the bridge in February 2020 revealed structural cracking which recommended the commissioning of a further intrusive survey. This subsequent survey confirmed that the bridge had deteriorated to the extent that it was necessary to implement a 7.5 tonne weight restriction with immediate effect.

In 1998 protective works were undertaken to the deck structure therefore, based on the previous inspection report, the deterioration identified in 2020 was much more significant than expected, and not reasonably foreseen.

Since the introduction of the weight restriction the Comhairle has been focused on ensuring that services associated with the health, safety and welfare of residents are facilitated. Emergency services and utility providers have contingency plans for working around the weight restriction. Fuel providers have also been collaborative in arranging for alternative means of maintaining supplies.

Enquiries have been made in relation to materials and equipment for construction projects. Although the Comhairle would be happy to discuss specific one-off deliveries unfortunately sustaining the level of resources required for a complete house build would not be practical.

The sea crossing trial, which would also provide for fuel deliveries, has proven difficult to deploy due to weather conditions. It is, however, hoped to get this to happen in the coming week. An alternative vessel provider, who is currently working in the area, was approached with a view to undertaking this crossing, however the appropriate certification for carrying dangerous goods (tankered fuel) is not in place for the vessel (MV James).

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Welcome to the 9th edition of the

Bernera News. The nights are drawing in, the temperature continues to drop, and the surrounding landscape is slowly changing into its Winter palette.

The roar of stags can once again be heard and, on occasion, the familiar roar of the Hebridean winds. We hope that all of you came through the first of our winter storms relatively unscathed?

This issue our thoughts turn to remembrance, and to how we can help others within our communities. It will feel very strange not to stand at a memorial this week in order to give thanks to those who paid the ultimate sacrifice. Instead, I hope that many of us will find time to take a moment of quiet, and to remember those no longer with us.

In these difficult and strange times we perhaps ought to also consider those within our community who may be struggling more than usual. We have details of two ways that you may feel able to help through excellent local organisations.

We also include the virtual craft fair. Many people have lost income this year, and we'd like to support all within our community by encouraging you to buy local where possible.

Contact us at: 01851 600 159
Text/Whatsapp: 07958 549784
Email: hello@thedailyceilidh.co.uk
Or visit us online at:
www.thedailyceilidh.co.uk

Should the transport of gas not be possible next week then alternative bottled gas conversions will be considered for those affected. The Scottish Salmon Company has been assisting the Comhairle with facilitating landings. Ferguson Marine and O'Malley Marine Plant have been in discussions in facilitating a suitable vessel for the proposed sailings.

Meantime, progress is being made in the procurement of a replacement bridge structure. Although being referred to as temporary, the structure will have a minimum design life of 30 years. The normal design life for such a structure would be 120 years.

The Marine Licence application has been accepted and a 28 day public consultation will commence within the next few days. The amount of work that is required pre application is considerable, and in this case has resulted in a fast track approach by Marine Scotland.

A planning application has been submitted and awaiting determination. Land acquisition is in progress with both estates.

It is hoped that the necessary approvals and land acquisitions will be concluded by December 2020 allowing a start on site immediately thereafter. Within this anticipated timescale completion of the new crossing will be in March/April 2021. The Comhairle appreciate the difficulties this restriction is causing for the residents of Bernera and values the continued support of the community. A plan of the prospective works can be found on The Daily Ceilidh website at: www.thedailyceilidh.co.uk/bridge



BERNERA BRIDGE ACTION GROUP

Bernera residents interested in joining an independent action group to ensure that concerns are raised and that CNES understands the full issues facing us, are invited to fill in this form at <http://bit.ly/BerneraBridge> or ring **07894516609** to have your details/concerns added and ensure all voices are heard.

LANGABHAT MEDICAL PRACTICE

Please note that the practice email address has changed to: wi.langabhat@nhs.scot

COVID-19 UPDATE

Information correct as of 5/11/20

Despite England returning to a countrywide lockdown, the Scottish Government have not currently announced any plans to follow suit. Instead, local authority areas continue to be rated into different levels of restrictions. Comhairle nan Eilean Siar is currently allocated as level 1.

At this time you should not meet anyone who is not in your household indoors in your home, or in their home. You can, however, meet people from other households outdoors in a private garden or in a public place, such as a park. The maximum number of people who can meet outdoors is 6, which can be from up to 2 separate households. Children under the age of 12 from these households do not count towards the total number of people counted in a gathering.

Social distancing should be maintained at all times when meeting other households, although children under the age of 12 do not have to maintain distance from each other. Young people aged between 12 and 17 can meet in groups of up to 6 at a time outdoors, and are not subject to the 2 household limit. However, physical distancing is still required.

NHS WESTERN ISLES

It is asked that people across the Western Isles continue to observe the Covid-19 restrictions that remain in place. If you have to travel to and from the mainland for essential reasons, you are asked to be extra vigilant for symptoms.

These include:

A fever, or high temperature
A new continuous cough
Loss or change in sense of taste or smell

If you have any symptoms at any time please self-isolate at home with your household and seek a test.

To access testing in the Western Isles, contact the Covid-19 Response Team on **01851 601151** or email **wi-hb.covid19queries@nhs.net**. The phone line is staffed from 9am to 5.30pm Monday to Friday, with an answering machine outwith these hours.

Alternatively you can complete the online Covid-19 Testing Program Referral Form (NHS Western Isles) at **www.coronavirus.wi.nhs.scot/?page_id=2195**

Remember:

F - Face coverings. These should be used in shops and on public transport.
A - Avoid crowded places.
C - Clean your hands frequently, using soap and water wherever possible
T - Two metres - observe physical distancing
S - Self-isolate and book a test if you are suffering any symptoms

Face Coverings

Not everyone can wear a face covering, and in current times, when wearing a face covering is mandatory for most, exemptions can be difficult to explain. From October 29th an official Scottish Government exemption card is available. Physical and digital exemption cards are available to request online at **www.exempt.scot** or via a free helpline on **0800 121 6240**. Please remember that this is only for those with genuine conditions, who cannot wear a face covering for whatever reason.

EILEAN SIAR FOODBANK CHRISTMAS APPEAL

Eilean Siar Foodbank's aim is to provide food parcels for anyone who needs it. We understand that sometimes people struggle and it's not easy, so we are here to provide help and support, as frequent as needed.

In addition to support throughout the year, we also provide over 300 families and individuals with a Christmas food box. These boxes contain extra special food, specifically for the individual / family, with an added festive/Christmas theme that will allow them to enjoy a little something special this Christmas.

We would be very grateful if anyone could donate items to help us with these Christmas boxes. Specifically the following: mince pies (at least 2 month best before date), Christmas cake, selection boxes, toiletries, etc. We work with the Co-op and Tesco, who have kindly allowed a drop of point for us within their supermarkets. Our volunteers then collect the food, box it and deliver (when possible) to individuals, families and agencies.

Eilean Siar Foodbank would like to thank everyone who has supported us so far this year.

THE SALVATION ARMY CHRISTMAS PRESENT APPEAL

Each year the Salvation Army Christmas Present Appeal supports families by providing presents for children and young people within our local communities. This year, in particular, we need your support. Christmas is going to be a difficult time for many, but by giving a gift to our present appeal you can make a real difference to a child's life. The appeal will run throughout November, so please donate new and unwrapped gifts to any of the drop off points throughout the islands. These will then be collected, isolated and then distributed to those families in need this Christmas. Monetary donations are also welcome, as is the donation of wrapping paper and gift bags.

We at the Daily Ceilidh have offered to arrange a drop off point and collection service in Bernera for anyone wishing to donate (not cash). Call us on **01851 600 159** to arrange. Email **stornoway@salvationarmy.co.uk**, or call **07493 880058** to find out more. Further information can also be found on their Facebook page, search 'Stornoway Salvation Army'.

The Salvation Army believes every child deserves a new gift at Christmas so are unable to take used or second hand items for the Christmas Present Appeal. If you're looking for a suggested donation contact the Salvation Army, or ourselves, who will be able to help.

GREAT BERNERA COMMUNITY DEVELOPMENT TRUST

Annual General Meeting 2020 (Zoom)

The AGM of the Great Bernera Community Development Trust will be held on Monday 7th December 2020 at 7.30pm. The meeting will be conducted on Zoom, due to Covid 19 restrictions.

All Bernera residents are welcome to attend the meeting, and non-members are welcome to join the Trust for a contribution of £1.

To obtain the link for the AGM Zoom meeting, please email **macaulayj870@aol.com**, and you will be sent the link to be used to access the meeting.

Any Bernera resident who wishes to stand as a Trustee/Director of the Trust may do so, and should request a nomination form by emailing **trustbernera@hotmail.com**.

HISTORY QUIZ

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| 1. James VI mother was who | 17. Elizabeth I wore armour to address troops here |
| 2. What is the oldest part of the Tower of London | 18. China fought the Opium War with which country |
| 3. MacBeth is a real king of Scots true/false | 19. Sir Walter Scott lived in his border home |
| 4. Cecil Rhodes founded the country now called | 20. Bernera village turned into part of Linshader farm in 1823 |
| 5. Which 20th century year saw 3 British kings | 21. The Churchill Barriers protect which anchorage |
| 6. The make of coat Harold Wilson made famous | 22. Where did North Sea oil come ashore in Scotland |
| 7. Royal Navy's first iron hulled warship | 23. Somerled, died 1164, was mid 12th Century what |
| 8. The RSS Discovery is on display in which city | 24. Van Diemens Land is now known as |
| 9. The first printed bible | 25. Merlin was an advisor to whom |
| 10. George V changed family name to Windsor in | 26. Edinburgh Georgian built area called the |
| 11. Alexander The Great was first a king where | 27. Castle dominating north coast of the Clyde |
| 12. Responsible for the great railway axing in 60s | 28. Home of BBCs first regular TV broadcasts |
| 13. Longest Roman road in Britain | 29. Skye Terrier who guarded master grave till 1872 |
| 14. The Pirate Port in Jamaica founded 1494 | 30. In which church did The Bruce kill the Red Comyn |
| 15. Who conquered and ended the Aztec Empire | |
| 16. Steam Train that holds the world speed record | |

Answers in next issue of Bernera News

Colin Halliday
Kirkibost



VIRTUAL CRAFT FAIR

Due to covid restrictions this year meaning that Christmas Fairs were unlikely to be allowed, we thought we'd organise a "virtual" craft fair instead.

We have been in touch with as many different artists, craftspeople, and small businesses from the Bernera and Uig area as we could find, and invited them to advertise here. It has already been a difficult year for so many of our local producers and businesses, so we hope that you will support them and buy local where possible.

Please note that if any of you struggle to access the internet and wish to get in touch with any of the sellers listed below just give us a call on **01851 600 159**, and we can put you in touch directly.

Cheeky Fish Creations (Kirkibost)

These large heavyweight 1 litre glass bottles are decorated using a combination of decoupage techniques and silver metal leaf. The top has been finished with removable festive foliage and a hessian bow - perfect for Christmas and all year round. Underneath the cork is a string of battery powered warm white fairy lights. The bottles are £25 each, or two for £44. Local collection is available, or they can be posted for £3.



Made from chunky MDF, these are free standing and can be used year after year - or you can collect the different designs each year and grow yourself a herd!

Painted in metallic antique gold, with a jingle bell around the neck, red sparkly noses, and either holly leaves or glitter snowflakes on the antlers. There's also a personalised option with the recipients' name on a large

tree at the reindeers' feet. Personalised reindeer are £8, non-personalised are £7, both include a Kinder egg. Local collection is available, or postage is available at £3.10 which covers up to 4 reindeer.

If you'd like to place an order please get in touch by searching 'Cheeky Fish Creations' on Facebook.

Please note, as these are made to order please allow around 2 weeks for your order to be made up, to allow for various stages and drying in between.

Ros Paterson - artist (Kirkibost)

Treat yourself, or others, to beautiful and unique hanging ornaments. All hand painted by Ros on Bernera. They make fantastic tree decorations, but can equally be used all year round to add a splash of drama and colour.

Aurora and Frost hanging ornaments. Small (4.5x4.5cm) £12 each

Starry Night hanging ornaments. Small (4.5x4.5cm) £12 each, Large (6x6cm) £15 each

Deer hanging ornaments. Small (4.5x4.5cm) £12 each, Large (6x6cm) £15 each

Ros also has some stunning artworks for sale. We particularly love these triptychs (a piece of art with three panels) Triptychs £35 each

Search for "Ros Paterson Artist" on Facebook or email rospaterson@live.com



VIRTUAL CRAFT FAIR

Fighe Wool Crafts (Kirkibost)

Friends Jo George and Chris Taylor have been making wool crafts and offering craft workshops using locally sourced materials for several years.

Chris has a range of wonderful thick and warm, knitted woollen rugs for sale. These come in a variety of sizes and colours and are great for in the bothy, in front of the fire or on the sofa.

Joanna, offers a range of felt and tweed brooches, felted notebooks (with handmade paper) and handmade felt pots, all made using locally sourced and recycled wool.

Alternatively, if you are looking for a more novel Christmas present this year – we have for sale 'Bothy Rug Knitting Kits'. These comprise of instructions, giant knitting needles or crochet hooks (18mm width) and 1.5 kg balls of wool to knit or crochet your own rug!



Rug and pillow commissions (specific colours and sizes) are also welcome.

All can be bought either online (see website below), direct from us at 26 Kirkibost (with social distancing), or the smaller rugs can also be bought from Uig shop.

For more info please visit www.fighewoolcrafts.co.uk or email: jogeorge6688@outlook.com tel: 07771534058



Hebridean Baskets by Dawn Susan (Croir)



Handmade baskets and willow work, made using willow grown organically on the croft.

Simple round baskets. From 6 inches in diameter and upwards, these baskets make an excellent gift. From £17 depending on size and weaving technique.

Frame baskets. Available in different sizes from 8 inch diameter and upwards. They can be round or oval, and there are various different designs.

From £22 depending on size.

One similar to the photo would be around £35.

Willow fish. Always a popular gift. From £3.20 for a small fish.



Baskets can be made to order. Have a look at my Facebook page and website for ideas. www.hebrideanbaskets.co.uk or search 'Dawn Susan artist' on Facebook. Lewis Revival and Uig shop both sell my work if you want to get something off the shelf.

Hannah Mackay, Independent Usborne Organiser (Uig)



I have a selection of books in stock and will also be placing orders in the run up to Christmas.

Please get in touch if you'd like to place an order. The full catalogue is available online. Email: hannah7nb@hotmail.co.uk or phone/text 07814682991 for more details.

VIRTUAL CRAFT FAIR

June MacInnes - Avon (Breaclete)



Avon now sells a variety of products including skincare, toiletries, fashion, homeware, fragrance and much more. Contact me, your local Avon representative, on 07919 988381 or email me at cjjune@aol.com if you require the latest catalogue.

Or if you prefer to order online you can do so through my online store www.avon.uk.com/store/shopwithjune

Orders can be delivered directly to your door if required.



Halbert Candles and Crafts (Ardroil, Uig)



Beeswax candles, hand made in Uig, in various forms including the famous Lewis Chessmen.

Also available are chessmen and other figures made using local sand.

Prices range from £2 - £12.
Email Ellie at mamaelliebelle@hotmail.com, search on facebook for 'Halbert Candles and Crafts', or visit our Wee Shop, by the side of the road leading to the beach in Ardroil. A small collection of items are also available in Bernera Shop.



BERNERA BAKES... CAREEN'S SCRUMPTIOUS DOUGHNUTS

Ingredients:

8oz flour
1 ½ tsps baking powder
1oz margarine
2oz caster sugar
1 egg
Little milk
Oil to fry
Caster sugar mixed with a pinch of cinnamon



Method:

- Sift flour & baking powder in a bowl
- Rub in margarine, until it resembles breadcrumbs
- Add sugar and mix well
- Add egg and a little milk, mixing until it forms a smooth dough
- Roll out on a floured surface and cut into doughnut shapes
- Deep fry for 4 to 5 mins until golden brown and cooked through
- Drain doughnuts on kitchen paper & then dip into caster sugar/cinnamon mixture



Careen MacLennan
Kirkibost

DO YOU REMEMBER ?

Recently I have been having problems with my laptop, particularly with its memory. As always, Mr Google, The Daily Ceilidh, and Techmobile are at hand to help. Computer memory is essential for the effective operation and management of any IT system, recording digitally for us all our documents, programs, emails, photographs and videos.

We marvel at its speed of accessing a large volume of data in an instant, able to recall information so quickly and easily at the tap of one's finger. Whilst we may ponder with awe the capacities and capabilities of computers and their great memories how much greater and more wonderful are our own memories. All powered without a battery or an electrical socket.

A memory that recalls from our youngest years: situations, people, smells, feelings, phrases, speeches, languages, impressions, etc. Simply by thinking, a memory is immediately recollected. Often illustrated by pictures our minds paint as we are cerebrally taken back to that very place, conversation, or situation in an instant.

Yet, like computer memories, the human memory can also degrade in its abilities. Age, accidents, and disease can all take their toll so that we cannot remember that fact, that name, that conversation, as easily as we once could.

Whilst a gradual loss of memory function is the general rule for all as we age, for some it is much more of a challenge.

It is at this point, in knowing Jesus as our Lord and Saviour, we are assured in our faith and in our trust in Him; that even if we lose our memory, even our memory of Him, 'He remains faithful'. His love for us and His care of us shall continue, hour by hour and day by day.

Yet, unlike His people, the Lord has a perfect memory. He remembers everything He has ever created, and is unable to forget anything because of His all-knowingness.

It is at this point that God reveals the greatness of His love for His people. Not that He has forgotten all their wrongs done against Him by them in their sinful unbelief, He has personally chosen not to remember their wrongs anymore, for Christ's sake.

A love that ensures that He holds on to us when cognitively our minds may let Him go, through every facet of life. Ensuring that nothing shall be able 'to separate us from the love of God which is in Christ Jesus our Lord' not even senility, Alzheimer's disease, or any other thing.

Rev Hugh Maurice Stewart
Uig & Bernera



REMEMBRANCE SUNDAY

Unfortunately, due to restrictions to manage the pandemic, local remembrance events will not be able to proceed as they have in previous years. Instead, those who want to honour the fallen are asked to do so in the following ways:

Joining the two-minute silence at 11.00 on Sunday 8th November from their doorstep
Displaying a poppy (there's an excellent one to download on the Scottish Poppy Appeal website)
Giving to the Scottish Poppy Appeal to support the important work it does with the Armed Forces community across Scotland.

Donations can be made at a number of shops across the islands (including Bernera Shop), or through the Scottish Poppy Appeal website.

www.poppyscotland.org.uk

They shall grow not old, as we that are left grow old:

Age shall not weary them, nor the years condemn

At the going down of the sun and in the morning we will remember them

